



Plants for allergy sufferers

Gardens filled with pollen-rich plants are great for attracting bees and butterflies, but they can also promote allergy attacks.

If you have an allergy, choose plants with complex flower forms, such as fully double roses or pompom dahlias, whose intricate petals trap pollen inside the blooms. Weeds can produce large quantities of pollen, so remove them promptly before they flower, and do not plant ornamental grasses that, like their wild cousins, are responsible for the majority of allergic reactions. As well as planting low-allergen flowers, consider a boundary hedge, which may help reduce allergy attacks by trapping wind-borne pollen and preventing it from flying into your garden.



PERENNIAL LARGE

Agave americana

CENTURY PLANT A low-allergen plant, this evergreen perennial has lance-shaped, sharply pointed gray-green leaves. Mature plants bear cream flowers. Grow in a pot; overwinter indoors. 'Variegata' (above) has cream-edged leaves.

±5ft (1.5m)

☀️ 🌞 Z9–11 🌿



PERENNIAL SMALL

Ajuga reptans 'Atropurpurea'

BUGLEWEED A rhizome-forming evergreen perennial with rosettes of glossy bronze-purple leaves and short blue spring flower spikes, with a low pollen content. Spreading freely by runners, it forms good ground cover. Considered invasive in some areas.

±6in (15cm) ↔3ft (1m)

☀️ 🌞 🌿 Z3–9



PERENNIAL LARGE

Agapanthus Headbourne hybrids

AFRICAN LILY This perennial has strap-shaped foliage and spherical clusters of blue late summer to early fall flowers that produce little pollen. Grow in a sheltered site in free-draining soil; mulch in winter.

±4ft (1.2m) ↔24in (60cm)

☀️ 🌞 Z6–9



BULB LARGE

Allium 'Purple Sensation'

FLOWERING ONION This perennial bulb has sturdy stems of spherical purple flower heads in early summer, which produce little pollen. Plant the bulbs in groups in fall between perennials that will disguise the leaves, which fade as the flowers form.

±32in (80cm)

☀️ 🌞 🌿 Z3–8



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Campanula trachelium

NETTLE-LEAVED BELLFLOWER This tough perennial has nettle-like toothed leaves and tall leafy stems that hold clusters of bell-shaped blue to lilac flowers in summer. 'Bernice' has lilac-blue double flowers that are ideal for allergy sufferers.

±3ft (1m)

☀️ 🌞 🌿 Z4–8



BULB LARGE

Dahlia 'Franz Kafka'

POMPOM DAHLIA This tuber produces mauve-pink blooms that contain little pollen. The flowers appear on long stems above divided green leaves and look good in beds or large containers of gritty soil-based potting mix.

±32in (80cm)

☀️ 🌞 Z9–11



BAMBOO LARGE

Fargesia murielae

UMBRELLA BAMBOO This large clump-forming evergreen bamboo is perfect for allergy sufferers, since it rarely produces flowers. Use the arching yellow-green canes and lance-shaped, bright green leaves to create a screen or focal point.

±12ft (4m) ↔indefinite

☀️ 🌞 🌿 Z5–9



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Geranium psilostemon

ARMENIAN CRANESBILL A clump-forming perennial, ideal for a low-allergen garden. It produces lobed, toothed midgreen leaves that turn red in fall and saucer-shaped magenta flowers from early- to late summer with black centers and veins.

±24in (60cm)

☀️ 🌞 Z4–9



ANNUAL/BIENNIAL MEDIUM

Helianthus annuus

SUNFLOWER A robust annual with heart-shaped leaves and large daisy-like, orange or yellow flowers in summer, followed by edible seedheads. Double-flowered varieties, such as 'Teddy Bear' (above), are good choices for allergy sufferers.

±up to 3ft (1m) ↔24in (60cm)

☀️ 🌞 🌿